

Written to be handed over. Fill in the blanks, or leave it as it is — most of it is true for a lot of us.

When I tell you I'm autistic or ADHD

PLEASE DON'T SAY	TRY INSTEAD
"You don't seem autistic."	"Thanks for telling me."
"Everyone's a bit like that."	"What's it like for you?"
"Have you tried yoga / a diet?"	"Is there anything that would help?"
"But you're doing so well!"	"That must take a lot of effort."
"Isn't everyone on the spectrum?"	"I'll read up on it myself."

In everyday life, it helps if you

- ☐ Send it in writing, not just say it
- ☐ Ask before touching me
- ☐ Let me leave early without a fuss
- ☐ Give notice before plans change
- ☐ Say what you mean, plainly
- ☐ Don't take flat tone personally

If I go quiet or shut down

Stop talking. Turn the noise and lights down.

Don't ask questions — I can't answer them yet.

Stay nearby but don't crowd me.

Don't try to fix it. It passes.

The specific thing I'd most like you to know

You don't have to understand it all. You just have to believe me.